600 1866 Extremely Fine and a perfectly beautiful example with some prooflike surface and golden toning.

601 1867 Very Fine, even wear, small obverse edge nick.

Lot No. 602

602 **1868** About Uncirculated and a prooflike "First Strike." Rather scarce in the upper grades.

603 1869 Extremely Fine, lustrous in the devices. Only 2,525 were coined.

604 1870 Extremely Fine, polished some years ago, now toning to olive-golden.

SUPERB 1871 THREE DOLLAR GOLD

Lot No. 605

605 **1871 Choice Brilliant Uncirculated.** A superb example with prooflike surface. Of the 1,300 coined for circulation possibly only 15% are extant. In this condition, however, the cataloguer doubts if there are ten coins this nice. ***(SEE COLOR PLATE)***

606 1872 About Uncirculated and a choice example with pale orange toning. Very scarce.

RARE 1873 THREE DOLLAR GOLD

Lot No. 607

607 **1873 Closed 3.** Extremely Fine but heavily cleaned, some lustre still is apparent in the devices. Light orange toning. One of the "key" dates of the series.

608 1874 About Uncirculated and frosty.

609 1874 Another. Extremely Fine.

EXTREMELY RARE

1875 PROOF THREE DOLLAR GOLD

Lot No. 610

(Enlarged) *(Enlarged)*

610 **1875 Choice Brilliant Proof.** *20 specimens reported struck.* A lovely specimen with but a few microscopic hairlines. A needle-sharp strike with the ever-present "aura" about the head, peculiar to these late date proofs. Some copper stains on the denticles on the obverse. This beautiful, deep yellow gold rarity is a virtual twin to the coin we sold in our Western Collection, December 1981. A ***great rarity*** with the potential of a six figure bid. ***(SEE COLOR PLATE)***

VERY RARE

1876 PROOF THREE DOLLAR GOLD

Lot No. 611

(Enlarged) *(Enlarged)*

611 **1876 Choice Brilliant Proof.** *45 specimens struck.* A perfect companion piece to the 1875 previously offered. A virtual gem with the "aura" about the head. This, too, is a twin to the specimen sold in our Western Sale. ***Like the 1875, the 1876 is a "Proof only" date.*** Well worth a bid in excess of $25,000.00. ***(SEE COLOR PLATE)***

612 1877 Very Fine but formerly mounted on the rim above the head. The mounting was neatly removed. Rare as only 1,488 were struck.

613 1878 About Uncirculated and frosty. A few bagmarks on the cheek.

Lot No. 614

614 **1879 Choice Brilliant Uncirculated.** Full blazing lustre with pale pink toning. Very attractive.

Lot No. 615

615 **1879** Another example. **Choice Brilliant Uncirculated,** full blazing lustre with light bagmarks.

616 1879 A third example. Extremely Fine and prooflike, a small reverse rub above the date.

617 1879 A fourth specimen. Very Fine with some small edge nicks.

The following group of Three Dollar gold pieces were all buffed to a mirror-like appearance. They seem to resemble the work of a dentist years ago who polished all of his coins to look like Proofs.

618 1879 Extremely Fine, buffed.

619 1880 Extremely Fine, buffed.

Lot No. 620

620 **1881** Extremely Fine, buffed. Only 500 "business strikes."